



[GUIDEBOOK] - Zero Human Company Hackathon by TeraC

Thank you so much for coming to the World's First Zero Hackathon! This event would not have been possible unless it was for our amazing sponsors! Read through this guide to see how you can redeem all of your hackathon credits and benefits.

***You may compete in as many tracks as you want, as long as your project meets the criteria for those tracks. The more tracks you compete in, the higher your odds are of winning.**

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Location, Slack, Project Submission



Humanmade - 655 Bryant St, San Francisco, CA 94107



[Join this Slack for communications, to ask questions, and get help](#)



[Submit your projects through this link](#)

Schedule (August 15th, 8:30am – 9:00pm)

Time	Block
8:30 – 9:00	Doors open &, check-in
9:00 – 9:15	Welcome
9:15 – 9:45	Opening Ceremony — rules, judging c shared here
9:45 – 10:20	Sponsor stage time (mandatory) — R
10:20 – 10:45	Sponsor Q&A at booths (credits/API c
10:45	Hacking begins
11:30	<i>Lunch sponsored by Egoist Machines</i>
10:45 – 6:45	Core hacking block (8 hrs) — lunch &
6:15	Dinner!
6:45	Submissions LOCK
7:00 – 8:00	Judging
7:15-7:45	Speaker Panel (Brief Intros → Moder
8:00 – 8:20	Winner compilation and judges finaliz
8:20 – 8:50	Closing Ceremony: winners announce
8:50 – 9:00	Wrap-up

Judges



Ilia Bolgov // Co-Founder & CEO @ Touchmark
(YC S26)

Product Owner @ Revolut // Maths & Finance @
Imperial College London

Best Overall Project



Roman Yanushevskyi // Co-Founder & CTO @
Touchmark (YC S26)

AI Engineer @ Lovable // Quant @ Citadel
Securities

Best Overall Project



Om Buddhdev // Co-founder & CEO @ Olam Labs (YC S26)

Engineer @ Latitude // Global T25 Valorant Player w/ 200k+ Followers

Best Overall Project



Shreshth Sharma // Co-Founder & CTO @
Olam Labs (YC S26)

Data Scientist @ RBC // Math, CS, and Business
@ Waterloo

Best Overall Project



Shubh Mittal // Founder @ Stealth

MTS @ xAI // Engineer @ AGI Inc.

Best Overall Project



Sarthak Ahuja // Co-Founder @ Brekfuz

Founder @ GR8ER // Z Fellow & CS @ UIUC

Best Overall Agent-Run Company, Best use of Render



Arhan Singhal // Co-Founder @ Brekfuz

Founder @ SecureSense // Z Fellow & AI @
UPenn

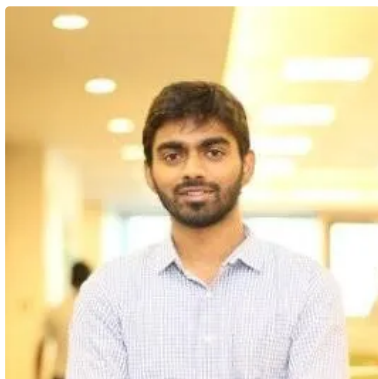
*Best Overall Agent-Run Company, Best use of
Render*



Tosh Rayadhurgam // Head of Advanced AI @
Stripe

Engineering Leader @ Meta // Engineering Lead
@ Lyft & Amazon Lab126

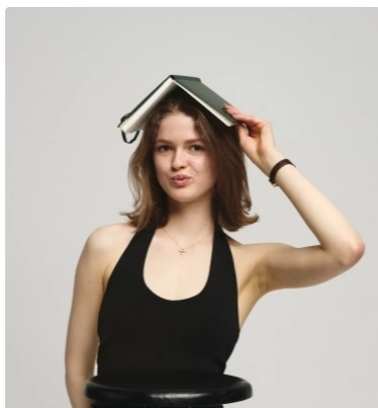
*Best Overall Agent-Run Company, Best use of
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Shriram Bagavathyappan // Group PM @
Google Deepmind

Senior PM @ Youtube & Flipkart // Head of
Product @ Housing.com

*Best Overall Agent-Run Company, Best use of
Render*



Erin Meryl McGurk // Founder @ Egoist
Machines (YC S26)

Content Creator (1M+ Followers) // University of Cambridge

Best Overall Agent-Run Company, Best use of Render



Harry Kapoor // Founder @ Stealth

Product & Growth @ CRED // Serial Founder

Best Overall Agent-Run Company, Best use of Render

Speakers



Ari Dutilh // Media & Talent @ Solo Founders
and ODF

Co-Founder @ Bagel Fund // Founder @
Photography Lounge



Danielle Strachman // Founder & GP @ 1517
Fund

Director @ Thiel Fellowship // Founder @
Innovations Academy

Rules for ALL PROJECTS

- Build an agent, or multiple, that work in unison to run a company autonomously.

Everything from:

- building the product
- marketing & outbounds
- selling to customers
- handling payments
- legal/compliance
- making hard decisions
- *and everything in between*

- All projects must use the Terac MCP
 - **Criteria:** Use real human input you collect during the hackathon to make your project measurably better, whether that's product feedback, user testing, expert judgment, or labeled data.
 - **Build something real people can respond to.** An app people can use, react to, label, rate, rank, or compare.
 - **Call the Terac API/MCP to bring the people.** We handle recruiting and incentives.
 - **Turn that input into a better project.** Show a clear before and after.
 - *Please launch studies geared towards the General Population, so you get the fastest & best results*
- To collect payments, and be eligible for the "Best Overall Agent-Run Company," you must setup a stripe individual account which you'll collect payments through
 - ¶ [REQUIRED] - How to set up payment

Tracks and Prizes

Best Overall Project

- Prize: \$2500
- **Criteria:** The best overall project, decided on by the main panel of judges. Creativity, technical skill, and it's impressiveness, overall!

Best Overall Agent-Run Company

- Prize: \$2500
- **Criteria:** The agent-run company that earns real revenue during the hackathon and also has the most potential to be a successful company, post-hackathon.

Best use of Linq

- 1st Place - \$1,500
- 2nd Place - \$1000

- **Criteria:** Linq gives your agent a *real phone number* on *iMessage* — iMessage, RCS and SMS from one API, plus rich media, Find My location, effects, reactions, typing indicators, read receipts, and realtime webhooks on every event. The part most people don't know about: iMessage Apps, an interactive card that renders inside iMessage — a game board redraws after a move, an order flips from "Reserved" to "Confirmed" in the familiar blue bubble. And with Agent Pay, checkout happens right there: the payment card opens an Apple Pay App Clip, and the money settles to your own Stripe account.

Best use of Replay

- 1st Place - \$1000
- 2nd Place - \$500
- Report a QA false positives for a \$50 amazon gift card
- **Criteria:** Build a great app and get a clean report from QA after fixing the bugs it finds

Best use of Superserve

- 1st Place - \$1000
- 2nd Place - \$500

- **Criteria:** Teams must use Superserve as core part of their project stack to qualify for winner prizes. Teams can give their agents virtual machines in the cloud with Superserve. Any time agents need to execute code, manage files, run bash commands, use a browser, etc. they can do so safely in Superserve sandboxes. Between turns, agents can pause the sandbox preserving full VM state, and resume instantly on subsequent turns.

Best use of Pioneer

- 1st Place - \$500
- **Criteria:** Use open-weight model(s) on Pioneer to build a compelling product
 - Bonus points:
 - Use Fastino Labs models
 - GLiNER2, GLiGuard, or GLiNER2-Pll
 - OR Fine-tune an open model using Pioneer fine-tuning API.
Doc here:
<https://docs.pioneer.ai/guides/fine-tune-llm>

Best use of Band

- 1st Place - \$500
- **Criteria:** Project uses Band meaningfully. What is "meaningfully"? it's when the coordination between agents happens *in* Band, and taking Band out breaks the project. Meaningful use of Band means the chat room actually drives the collaboration, not just displays it, remove the room and the app should break, not keep working the same way. That requires at least one real dependency: a handoff where one agent's answer changes because of another's finding, a specialist added at runtime based on the specific case, a boundary Band enforces between accounts, or a verdict one agent can genuinely block.
- <https://www.band.ai/hacker-guide>

Best use of Render

- 1st Place - \$500 (in Render credits)
- 2nd Place - \$300 (in Render credits)
- 3rd Place - \$100 (in Render credits)
- **Criteria:** Projects must use [Render Workflows](#) to qualify for the winner prizes.

Sponsors & Partners

Thank you so much to our amazing sponsors and partners for making this event a reality!



Terac (Host) - A network of over 180,000+ experts contributing to frontier research. Human expertise on demand via an API & MCP.

 [Terac](#) [Terac | Get paid for your expertise](#)



Stripe - Payments infrastructure for the internet, powering online checkout, billing, and financial operations for millions of businesses worldwide.

 [stripe](#) [Stripe | Financial Infrastructure to Grow Your Revenue](#)



Lovable - An AI app builder that lets anyone create and ship web apps and websites just by describing what they want in plain language (vibe coding).

 [Lovable AI App Builder | Vibe Code Apps & Websites with AI, Fast](#)



Whop - Whop is the end-to-end API for running a business on the internet.

 [Whop Whop - Join the future of work](#)



Render - A cloud platform that makes it simple to deploy, host, and scale web apps, APIs, and databases without managing infrastructure.

 [Render Render | The cloud for builders](#)

ling

Linq - Builds AI assistant infrastructure that lives inside everyday messaging apps like iMessage and SMS, so people can interact with AI without leaving their texts.

 [Linq Communications APIs for iMessage, RCS, SMS, and Voice | Linq](#)

superserve

Superserve - Provides sandbox infrastructure for running long-lived AI agents, giving developers pay-as-you-go, isolated environments to safely execute agent workloads.

 [Superserve Superserve | The sandbox for long-running agents](#)

Replay

Replay - An AI-powered QA platform that automatically explores web apps, finds bugs, and delivers detailed reports with root causes and suggested fixes — no manual test writing required.

▶ [replayio](#) [Replay QA — AI wrote the app.](#)
[Replay QA finds what broke.](#)



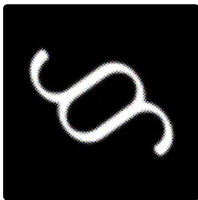
Pioneer by Fastino Labs - An AI agent that lets developers fine-tune and deploy open-source language models (like Qwen, Gemma, and Llama) in minutes with a single prompt.

* [Pioneer AI: Model Routing, Adaptive Inference & Fine-Tuning](#)



Band - Interaction infrastructure that lets AI agents (across different frameworks) and human teams communicate, coordinate, and collaborate in real time, with built-in governance.

 www.band.ai



Egoist Machines - Building AI Passport, a user-owned context layer that lets people carry their preferences, history, and intent across products. Developers get rich, permissioned user context through one integration, enabling better personalisation without building their own profiling and memory infrastructure.

 Egoist Machines, Inc. [Egoist AI Passport](#)



Dodo Payments - A billing and payments platform built for AI-first, SaaS, and digital-product companies, handling checkout, subscriptions, and global payouts as a Merchant of Record so founders can sell worldwide without setting up local entities.

 Dodo Payments [Billing & Payments Platform for AI-First Companies | Dodo Pa...](#)



SANDBOX0

sandbox0 - Open-source, secure sandbox infrastructure that gives AI agents isolated cloud environments to safely execute code and tasks.

 Sandbox0 Team [Sandbox0 - Persistent Sandboxes for AI Agents](#)



SOLARI

Solari by Pinetree Research - The fastest AI infra. Solari offers headless browsers, sandboxes, and desktops so your agents can run and execute in reliable environments. Built by Pinetree Research, an AI research lab building agents that can reliably operate real software and complete workflows in production settings.

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🌐 Solari, the fastest agent infrastructure

Interview Cake

Interview Cake - A technical interview prep platform that helps software engineers practice coding interview questions and land job offers.

 Interview Cake: Programming Interview Questions and Tips [Programming Interview Questions + Help Getting Job Offers | ...](#)

Nucleate Bay Area

Nucleate - Nucleate represents the largest global community of bio-innovators.

 Nucleate [Nucleate](#)

[REQUIRED] - How to set up payment

To be eligible for the main prize (Best Overall Project & Best Overall Agent-Run Company), we need to know how much revenue your agent earned throughout the day. You need to create a personal account on [Stripe](#) and share certain details with us so we can track how much you earn throughout the day. Please pay close attention and follow the steps below to ensure you're eligible for the prizes. |

These steps let your team accept real payments during the hackathon and let organizers track your revenue automatically, without sharing account access with anyone else.

1. Create your own Stripe account

1. Go to stripe.com and click **Sign up**.
2. Use your team's email (or one team member's email, whoever creates the account should stay reachable in case Stripe asks for verification info).
3. You do **not** need to complete full business verification to start collecting test/small payments, a personal account is fine for hackathon purposes. Skip any steps that ask for business documents unless Stripe blocks you from continuing.

2. Create a Payment Link

This is the link your agent will send to "customers" to collect payment.

1. In the Stripe Dashboard, go to **Payment links** (left sidebar, or search "Payment Links" in the top search bar).
2. Click **+ Create payment link**.
3. Add a product, name it something recognizable, like **[Your Team Name] Payment**.
4. Set a price. If your agent charges variable amounts, choose **Customer chooses price** so you don't need a new link for every transaction.
5. Click **Create link**.
6. Copy the link, this is what your agent should use whenever it needs to collect a payment. **Use this same link for every transaction during the hackathon.**

3. Create a Restricted API Key (read-only)

This gives organizers a way to see your revenue without giving anyone the ability to touch your money.

1. In the Dashboard, go to **Developers → API keys**.
2. Click **Create restricted key**.

3. Name it something like `hackathon-readonly`.
4. Under permissions, find these two resources and set each to **Read**:
 - **Balance**
 - **Charges**
5. Set every other permission to **None**: you want this key to only be able to *view* charges and balance, not create, refund, or move anything.
6. Click **Create key**.
7. Copy the key (it starts with `rk_`). You will not be able to see it again after this, if you lose it, just create a new one.

Important: never generate or share your regular **secret key** (starts with `sk_`), only ever share the restricted key described above. The restricted key cannot be used to charge cards, issue refunds, or withdraw funds, so it's safe to submit.

4. Submit to organizers

Submit the following three things:

- **Team name**
- **Payment Link URL** (from Step 2)

- **Restricted API key** (from Step 3, starts with `rk_`)

A few notes

- Only use the Payment Link you submitted, if you create a new one mid-hackathon, your revenue tracking will miss it. Let organizers know if you need to regenerate it.
- Do not share your Stripe login, secret key, or restricted key with anyone outside your team.
- Organizers will only ever see totals and transaction counts through the restricted key, never your login, never the ability to move funds.

Credits & Subscriptions - Redemption Guide

Terac

- *Please launch studies geared towards the General Population, so you get the fastest & best results*
- <https://terac.com/r/rGi7O0EfRbzmiElg8kRjES5W2JrKNYc>

Stripe

20% off Stripe Atlas and founders/developers who incorporate with Atlas also receive \$2,500 USD in Stripe credits and can create, send, and receive SAFEs straight from their Stripe dashboard.

Redeem Offer -

<https://dashboard.stripe.com/atlas/invite/b5zxto4k>

[More information](#)

Lovable

How it works

- The code gives access to Pro Plan 1 (100 credits) at no cost.
- Unlocks all Pro Plan 1 features for the duration of the plan.
- The code must be redeemed by the end of the event, and should not be shared with anyone outside of the event.

How to apply the code

1. Go to lovable.dev

2. If you don't have an account, click on "Get started" → Create an account.
3. If you have an account, go to Settings → Plans & Credits.
4. Select Pro Plan 1 (100 credits). Make sure to choose the monthly plan.
5. At checkout, enter your discount code: **COMM-THE-4G9T**

If any attendees already have a paid account, they'll just need to create a new workspace to redeem the code.

Please note: You may be asked to enter payment details, but you will have one month to cancel, and you can cancel the account as soon as it is activated.

Render

Credits - <https://credits-portal-mmdm.onrender.com/claim/terac-hackathon>

More info on credit redemption is available here: <https://render.com/docs/credits>.

Attendees can use these credits for any costs accrued by their workspace, including the plan fee, compute usage, bandwidth, and so on

Linq

Linq gives your agent a ***real phone number*** on ***iMessage***. Linq supports iMessage, RCS and SMS from one API, plus rich media, Find My location, effects, reactions, typing indicators, read receipts, and realtime webhooks on every event. The part most people don't know about: iMessage Apps, an interactive card that renders inside iMessage. Use it as a visual or interactive component: a game board redraws after a move, an order flips from "Reserved" to "Confirmed" in the familiar blue bubble. And with Payments support through our AgentCard, Stripe, and Natural integrations, your agent can now buy things for you.

To get started, follow these instructions:

1. Go to <https://linqapp.com/hackathon> to learn more about Linq.
2. Once you are ready, visit the [Sandbox Signup page](#) and select "**Hackathon**" in the "How did you hear about us?" dropdown.
3. Make sure to [apply our best practices instructions](#)
4. Let us know of any questions or if you run into any issues!

Idea starter: Build an agent and flow that takes advantage of iMessage Apps. Ideally you build something unique to a vertical, not a generic claude-wrapper bot. Additionally, the best projects will treat messaging primitives as UI: a 👍 tapback is a vote, a typing indicator is a loading state, a group thread is your multiplayer lobby.

In the past, we've seen teams: build a food ordering bot using the Doordash CLI, trade on Kalshi via Claude, and book a reservation via Resy.

Replay

Sign up at <https://qa.replay.io/> and enter the code: *HACKATHON* on the billing page for unlimited access during the hackathon

Superserve

Just sign up on <https://superserve.ai/> - no need to enter any payment info!

Pioneer by Fastino Labs

- Sign up: <https://agent.pioneer.ai>
- Use promo code ZeroHumanHack0826 to get free Pro plan and inference credits.

- Billing -> Get Pro -> enter the promo code above in Stripe checkout page

Band

Sign up at <https://www.band.ai/> and use code *HACKBANDAUG26* for a free month of the pro tier [Band Discord Server for help](#)
[Band Hacker Guide](#)

sandbox0

Solari by Pinetree Research

- Sign up: <https://console.getsolari.com>
 - Use promo code ZEROHUMANHACK-SWSYP3XJ to get 1-month access and Solari credits.
 - Billing -> enter the promo code above in Stripe checkout page
 - Code will grant access to the full Solari API and infra suite, including headless browsers, sandboxes, and desktops.

Interview Cake

Benefit: Access to full coding interview prep course for 7 days (\$50 value)

Subscription Redemption -

<http://interviewcake.com/r/V4RQ3M>

*Limited to the first 50 redemptions. Expires
September 30, 2026